

RISK vs. REWARD – Two-Page Pitch

How much would you bet you're right?

One-Hour Studio Game Show

Players: Solo Contestants or Couples

Prize Range: \$0.01 to \$1,000,000

LOGLINE

Contestants answer trivia questions—but before locking in an answer, they must decide how much they trust their choice. That decision determines how much they can win or lose and permanently shapes their path toward a \$1,000,000 prize.

THE HOOK

Everyone thinks they know the answer.

The real question is:

How much would you bet on yourself being right?

In RISK vs. REWARD, contestants don't just answer trivia—they continuously measure their own confidence under pressure, turning every question into a personal risk decision.

A correct answer is not enough. The size of your belief in that answer determines your outcome.

CORE IDEA (ONE SENTENCE)

Before locking in each answer, contestants use a dynamic slider to set their confidence—directly determining their potential winnings, losses, and their evolving path to the top prize.

WHY IT'S DIFFERENT

This is not a trivia show where knowing the answer is enough.

It is a game where:

- confidence matters as much as knowledge
- every decision has lasting consequences
- and early choices permanently shape what is still possible

Two equally skilled players can leave with radically different outcomes based entirely on how they manage risk and confidence.

HOW IT PLAYS

- 12-question studio game (no elimination)
- Contestants choose a category each round
- A multiple-choice question is revealed
- Contestant moves the RISK/REWARD Slider while watching the possible outcomes update in real time
- Lock-in answer → result revealed

FOR EVERY QUESTION

Every question forces one core decision:

Do I trust myself enough to risk more for a bigger reward?

The screenshot displays the 'RISK vs. REWARD' game interface. At the top, the title 'RISK vs. REWARD' is shown in red and green. Below it, the question is: 'Question: 1 Category: Landmarks. If you are facing the Mount Rushmore National Memorial, which President is shown on the far right side?'. Four multiple-choice options are listed: A) Thomas Jefferson, B) Theodore Roosevelt, C) Abraham Lincoln, and D) George Washington. A horizontal slider is positioned below the options, with a black dot indicating the current confidence level. To the left of the slider, a red box shows '-\$272.47 RISK'. To the right, a green box shows 'REWARD \$329.84'. Below the slider, a 'Countdown: 86' is displayed. At the bottom, there are two boxes: a red one for 'If you miss...' and a green one for 'If you are correct...'. The red box shows: 'You now have: \$533.87', 'Minus RISK: \$272.47', 'You would have: \$261.28', 'The Least You Can Win: \$0.01', and 'The Most You Can Win: \$251,178.56'. The green box shows: 'You now have: \$533.87', 'Plus REWARD: \$329.84', 'You would have: \$863.51', 'The Least You Can Win: \$0.04', and 'The Most You Can Win: \$830,362.85'. A 'Lock In Answer' button is at the bottom center.

Contestants see the question before committing to the RISK/REWARD Slider. As the slider moves, potential gains, losses, and future possibilities update instantly – making every decision fully informed before the answer is locked in.

Higher confidence:

- increases potential winnings
- increases potential losses
- preserves the possibility of reaching the \$1,000,000 prize

Lower confidence:

- reduces immediate risk
- limits immediate reward
- permanently reduces future maximum earning potential

Every choice reshapes what is still possible later in the game. Every decision changes not only what you can win now—but what you can still hope to win.

THE GAME WITHIN THE GAME

Contestants are constantly managing two things:

- what they know
- how sure they are that they know it

This creates a continuous psychological tension: confidence vs. caution, played out in real money in real time.

COUPLES MODE

Two contestants play as a team, jointly deciding answers and confidence levels. This turns every question into negotiation under pressure:

- disagreement becomes strategy
- persuasion becomes gameplay
- confidence gaps become conflict

Often, the biggest tension is not the trivia—it is agreement on risk.

WHY IT WORKS

RISK vs. REWARD turns confidence into something viewers can actually watch:

- Viewers instantly compare their own confidence to contestants
- Every decision has immediate and long-term consequences
- The game creates natural regret and “I would’ve done it differently” moments
- Real-time visual feedback makes every consequence easy to understand
- Couples Mode adds relationship tension and personality conflict

At its core, RISK vs. REWARD isn't about answering questions. It's about deciding how much to trust your own answers when money is on the line.

PLAY THE INTERACTIVE DEMO

A fully interactive prototype demonstrates the complete game system in real time.

Players select categories, answer questions, and adjust confidence using a dynamic slider that instantly updates winnings, risk exposure, and future earning potential before locking in decisions.

👉 <https://eddielawhorn.com/risk-vs-reward/game>

TAGLINE

*When the answer is revealed, contestants don't just discover whether they were right.
They discover whether they trusted themselves the right amount.*

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